



SECOND CHANCE HOME

Child and Adolescent
Needs and Strengths (CANS)
Assessment

(Children at Risk CAR and Children in Conflict with the LAW –CICL)

CODING DEFINITIONS & GUIDELINES

CANS Action Levels

The way the CANS works is that each item suggests different pathways for service or treatment planning. There are four levels of each item with anchored definitions; however, these definitions are designed to translate into the following action levels (separate for needs and strengths):

For Traumatic/Adverse Experiences domain. *Rate as lifetime exposure, not just current timeframe:*

- 0 - No evidence of any trauma of this type
- 1 - A single incident or trauma occurred or suspicion exists of this type of trauma
- 2 - Multiple incidents or a moderate degree of trauma of this type
- 3 - Repeated and severe incidents of trauma of this type

For Needs domains (Traumatic Stress Symptoms, Risk Behaviors, Behavioral/Emotional Needs, Life Domain Functioning, and Caregiver Needs). *Rate based on how the youth is doing over the past 30 days:*

- 0 - No evidence of a need /no need for action
- 1 - Watchful waiting /prevention/mild need
- 2 - Action needed/moderate need
- 3 - Immediate -- Intensive action /severe need

For Strengths domain:

- 0 - Centerpiece strength
- 1 - Useful Strength
- 2 - Strength has been identified in this area but it must be built
- 3 - No strength is identified in this area /no information

I. TRAUMA/ADVERSE EXPERIENCES

*For items 1 - 10 only, rate as **lifetime exposure, not just current timeframe***

*For **Trauma Experiences**, the following categories and action levels are used:*

***0** indicates a dimension where there is no evidence of any trauma of this type.*

***1** indicates a dimension where a single incident of trauma occurred or suspicion exists of trauma experiences.*

***2** indicates a dimension on which the youth has experienced multiple traumas or a moderate degree of trauma.*

***3** indicates a dimension which describes repeated and severe incidents of trauma with medical and physical consequences.*

1. SEXUAL ABUSE – *This rating describes the youth’s experience of sexual abuse.*

0	There is no evidence that youth has experienced sexual abuse.
1	There is a suspicion that the youth has experienced sexual abuse with some degree of evidence or the youth has experienced “mild” sexual abuse including but not limited to direct exposure to sexually explicit materials . Evidence for suspicion of sexual abuse could include evidence of sexually reactive behavior as well as exposure to a sexualized environment or Internet predation . Youth who have experienced secondary sexual abuse (e.g., witnessing sexual abuse, having a sibling sexually abused) also would be rated here.
2	Youth has experienced one or a couple of incidents of sexual abuse that were not chronic or severe. This might include a youth who has experienced molestation without penetration on a single occasion .
3	Youth has experienced severe or chronic sexual abuse with multiple episodes or lasting over an extended period of time . This abuse may have involved penetration, multiple perpetrators, and/or associated physical injury .

2. PHYSICAL ABUSE - *This rating describes the youth’s experience of physical abuse.*

0	There is no evidence that youth has experienced physical abuse.
1	There is a suspicion that youth has experienced physical abuse but no confirming evidence . Spanking without physical harm or threat of harm also qualifies.
2	Youth has experienced a moderate level of physical abuse and/or repeated forms of physical punishment (e.g., hitting, punching).
3	Youth has experienced severe and repeated physical abuse with intent to do harm and that causes sufficient physical harm to necessitate hospital treatment.

3. EMOTIONAL ABUSE - *This rating describes the degree of severity of emotional abuse, including verbal and nonverbal forms. Non-verbal abuse would include extended “silent treatment” and complete intentional ignoring of emotional needs. Verbal abuse would include threatening, insulting, and/or demeaning comments and/or characterizations of the youth.*

0	There is no evidence that youth has experienced emotional abuse.
1	Youth has experienced mild emotional abuse. For instance, youth may experience some insults or is occasionally referred to in a derogatory manner by caregivers.
2	Youth has experienced moderate degree of emotional abuse. For instance, youth may be consistently denied emotional attention from caregivers, insulted or humiliated on an ongoing basis , or intentionally isolated from others.
3	Youth has experienced significant or severe emotional abuse over an extended period of time (at least one year). For instance, youth is completely ignored by caregivers, or threatened/terrorized by others.

4. NEGLECT - *This rating describes the severity of neglect.*

0	There is no evidence that youth has experienced neglect.
1	Youth has experienced minor or occasional neglect. Youth may have been left at home alone for a short period of time with no adult supervision or there may be occasional failure to provide adequate supervision of child.
2	Youth has experienced a moderate level of neglect. This may include occasional unintended failure to provide adequate food, shelter, or clothing with corrective action.
3	Youth has experienced a severe level of neglect including multiple and/or prolonged absences by adults, without minimal supervision, and failure to provide basic necessities of life on a regular basis .

5. MEDICAL TRAUMA - *This rating describes the severity of medical trauma.*

0	There is no evidence that the youth has experienced medical trauma.
1	Youth has had a medical experience that was mildly overwhelming for the youth. Examples include events that were acute in nature and did not result in ongoing medical needs and associated distress such as minor surgery, stitches or a bone setting.
2	Youth has had a medical experience that was perceived as moderately emotionally or mentally overwhelming . Such events might include acute injuries and moderately invasive medical procedures such as major surgery that require only short term hospitalization.
3	Youth has had a medical experience that was perceived as extremely emotionally or mentally overwhelming . The event itself may have been life threatening and may have resulted in chronic health problems that alter the youth's physical functioning.

6. WITNESS TO FAMILY VIOLENCE - *This rating describes the severity of exposure to family violence.*

0	There is no evidence that youth has witnessed family violence.
1	Youth has witnessed one episode of family violence.
2	Youth has witnessed repeated episodes of family violence but no significant injuries (i.e., requiring emergency medical attention) have been witnessed.
3	Youth has witnessed repeated and severe episodes of family violence <u>or</u> has had to intervene in episodes of family violence. Significant injuries have occurred and have been witnessed by the youth as a direct result of the violence.

7. COMMUNITY/SCHOOL VIOLENCE – *This rating describes the severity of exposure to community violence, including the school setting.*

0	There is no evidence that youth has witnessed or experienced violence in school or community.
1	Youth has witnessed occasional fighting or other forms of violence in the community. Youth has not been directly impacted by community or school violence (i.e., violence not directed at self, family, or friends) and exposure has been limited.
2	Youth has witnessed multiple instances of community or school violence and/or the significant injury of others in his/her community, or has had friends/family members injured as a result of violence or criminal activity in the community, or is the direct victim of violence/criminal activity that was not life threatening .
3	Youth has witnessed or experienced severe and repeated instances of community and/or the death of another person in his/her community as a result of violence, or is the direct victim of violence/criminal activity in the community that was life threatening, or has experienced chronic/ongoing impact as a result of community or school violence (e.g., family member injured and no longer able to work).

8. TRAUMATIC GRIEF/SEPARATION - *This rating describes the experience of traumatic grief due to death, loss or separation from significant caregivers, siblings, or other significant figures.*

0	There is no evidence that the youth has experienced traumatic grief or separation from significant caregivers.
1	Youth has experienced some level of traumatic grief due to death or loss of a significant person or distress from caregiver separation in a manner that is appropriate given the recent nature of loss or separation.
2	Youth has experienced a moderate level of traumatic grief or difficulties with separation in a manner that impaired function in certain but not all areas for a significant period of time following the loss or separation. This could include withdrawal or isolation from others.
3	Youth has experienced a significant traumatic grief or separation reaction. Youth exhibited impaired functioning across several areas (e.g. interpersonal relationships, school) for a significant period of time following the loss or separation.

9. PARENTAL CRIMINAL BEHAVIOR (birth parents & legal guardians only) - *This item rates the criminal behavior of both biological and stepparents, and other legal guardians.*

0	There is no evidence that youth's parents have ever engaged in criminal behavior.
1	One of youth's parents has a history of criminal behavior but youth has not been in contact with this parent for at least one year .
2	One of youth's parents has a history of criminal behavior resulting in a conviction or incarceration and youth has been in contact with this parent in the past year.
3	Both of youth's parents have history of criminal behavior resulting in incarceration.

10. OTHER TRAUMA - *This rating refers to any other traumatic experience not specified by the items above (e.g., natural/manmade disaster, war, or terrorism). For instance, a youth may observe a caregiver who has been injured in a car accident or fire or has lived in an area where bombings took place.*

0	There is no evidence that the youth has experienced any other form of trauma.
1	Youth has experienced another form of trauma that was mildly overwhelming for the youth.
2	Youth has experienced another form of trauma that was perceived as moderately emotionally or mentally overwhelming .
3	Youth has experienced another form of trauma that was perceived as extremely emotionally or mentally overwhelming .

II. TRAUMATIC STRESS SYMPTOMS

These ratings describe a range of reactions that youth may exhibit to any of the variety of traumatic experiences described above. Unlike the Trauma/Adverse Experiences, which are cumulative over the youth's lifetime, these symptoms are rated based on how the youth is doing over the past 30 days.

For **Trauma Stress Symptoms**, the following categories and action levels are used:

- 0** indicates a dimension where there is no evidence of any needs.
- 1** indicates a dimension that requires monitoring, watchful waiting, or preventive activities.
- 2** indicates a dimension that requires action to ensure that this identified need or risk behavior is addressed.
- 3** indicates a dimension that requires immediate or intensive action.

11. ADJUSTMENT TO TRAUMA - *This item covers the youth's reaction to any of a variety of traumatic experiences – such as emotional, physical, or sexual abuse, separation from family members, traumatic grief/separation, witnessing violence, or the victimization or murder of family members or close friends. This dimension covers both adjustment disorders and posttraumatic stress disorder from DSM-IV. This item allows you to rate the overall severity of the broad range of symptoms they still may be experiencing. The remaining items on the CANS will allow you to rate the specific types of symptoms.*

0	Youth has not experienced any significant trauma <u>or</u> has adjusted well to traumatic/adverse youth experiences.
1	Youth has some mild problems with adjustment due to trauma that might ease with the passage of time. Youth may be in the process of recovering from a more extreme reaction to a traumatic experience.
2	Youth presents with a moderate level of symptoms . Symptoms can vary widely and may include sleeping or eating disturbances, regressive behavior, behavior problems or problems with attachment. Youth may have features of one or more diagnoses and may meet full criteria for a specific DSM diagnosis including but not limited to diagnoses of Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD) and adjustment.
3	Youth has severe symptoms as a result of traumatic or adverse childhood experiences that require intensive or immediate attention . Youth likely meets criteria for more than one diagnosis or would meet criteria for a developmental trauma disorder or a complex trauma disorder .

12. RE-EXPERIENCING - *These symptoms consist of intrusive memories or reminders of traumatic events, including nightmares, flashbacks, intense reliving of the events, and repetitive play with themes of specific traumatic experiences. These symptoms are part of the DSM-IV criteria for PTSD.*

0	This rating is given to a youth with no evidence of intrusive symptoms.
1	This rating is given to a youth with some problems with intrusions , including occasional nightmares about traumatic events.
2	This rating is given to a youth with moderate difficulties with intrusive symptoms . This youth may have recurrent frightening dreams with or without recognizable content or recurrent distressing thoughts, images, perceptions or memories of traumatic events. This youth may exhibit trauma-specific reenactments through repetitive play with themes of trauma or intense physiological reactions to exposure to traumatic cues .
3	This rating is given to a youth with severe intrusive symptoms . This youth may exhibit trauma-specific reenactments that include sexually or physically traumatizing other youth or sexual play with adults. This youth may also exhibit persistent flashbacks, illusions or hallucinations that make it difficult for the youth to function .

13. AVOIDANCE - *These symptoms include efforts to avoid stimuli associated with traumatic experiences. These symptoms are part of the DSM-IV criteria for PTSD.*

0	This rating is given to a youth with no evidence of avoidance symptoms.
1	This rating is given to a youth who exhibits some avoidance . This youth may exhibit one primary avoidant symptom , including efforts to avoid thoughts, feelings or conversations associated with the trauma .
2	This rating is given to a youth with moderate symptoms of avoidance . In addition to avoiding thoughts or feelings associated with the trauma, the youth may also avoid activities, places, or people that arouse recollections of the trauma.
3	This rating is given to a youth who exhibits significant or multiple avoidant symptoms . This youth may avoid thoughts and feelings as well as situations and people associated with the trauma and be unable to recall important aspects of the trauma .

14. NUMBING - *These symptoms include numbing responses that are part of the DSM-IV criteria for PTSD. These responses were not present before the trauma.*

0	This rating is given to a youth with no evidence of numbing responses.
1	This rating is given to a youth who exhibits some problems with numbing . This youth may have a restricted range of affect or be unable to express or experience certain emotions (e.g., anger or sadness).
2	This rating is given to a youth with moderately severe numbing responses. This youth may have a blunted or flat emotional state or have difficulty experiencing intense emotions or feel consistently detached or estranged from others following the traumatic experience.
3	This rating is given to a youth with significant numbing responses or multiple symptoms of numbing . This youth may have a markedly diminished interest or participation in significant activities and a sense of a foreshortened future .

15. DISSOCIATION - *Symptoms included in this dimension are daydreaming, spacing or blanking out, forgetfulness, fragmentation, detachment, and rapid changes in personality often associated with traumatic experiences. This dimension may be used to rate dissociative disorders (e.g., Dissociative Disorder NOS, Dissociative Identity Disorder) but can also exist when other diagnoses are primary (e.g., PTSD, depression)*

0	This rating is given to a youth with no evidence of dissociation.
1	This rating is given to a youth with minor dissociative problems , including some emotional numbing, avoidance or detachment, and some difficulty with forgetfulness, daydreaming, spacing or blanking out .
2	This rating is given to a youth with a moderate level of dissociation. This can include amnesia for traumatic experiences or inconsistent memory for trauma (e.g., remembers in one context but not another), more persistent or perplexing difficulties with forgetfulness (e.g., loses things easily, forgets basic information), frequent daydreaming or trance-like behavior , depersonalization and/or derealization. This rating would be used for someone who meets criteria for Dissociative Disorder NOS or another diagnosis that is specified "with dissociative features."
3	This rating is given to a youth with severe dissociative disturbance . This can include significant memory difficulties associated with trauma that also impede day to day functioning . Youth is frequently forgetful or confused about things he/she should know about (e.g., no memory for activities or whereabouts of previous day or hours). Youth shows rapid changes in personality or evidence of distinct personalities. Youth who meets criteria for Dissociative Identity Disorder or a more severe level of Dissociative Disorder NOS would be rated here .

III. RISK BEHAVIORS (RISK FACTORS)

Risk behaviors are the types of things that can get youth in trouble or put them in danger of harming themselves or others. Notice that the time frames for the ratings change, particularly for the '1' and '3' ratings away from the standard 30 day rating window. Please note that placement in a treatment /residential setting does not mean a risk behavior has been resolved. Consider keeping scores elevated if evidence suggests youth will once again exhibit this need after release (e.g., reoffend)

For **Risk Behaviors**, the following categories and action levels are used:

- 0** indicates a dimension where there is no evidence of any needs.
- 1** indicates a dimension that requires monitoring, watchful waiting, or preventive activities.
- 2** indicates a dimension that requires action to ensure that this identified need or risk behavior is addressed.
- 3** indicates a dimension that requires immediate or intensive action.

16. DANGER TO SELF - *This rating describes both suicidal and significant self-injurious behavior. A rating of '2' or '3' would indicate the need for a safety plan.*

0	Youth has no evidence or history of suicidal or self-injurious behaviors.
1	History of suicidal or self-injurious behaviors or significant ideation but no self-injurious behavior during the past 30 days.
2	Recent, (last 30 days) but not acute (today) suicidal ideation or gesture. Self-injurious in the past 30 days (including today) without suicidal ideation or intent.
3	Current suicidal ideation and intent in the past 24 hours.

17. DANGER TO OTHERS - *This rating includes actual and threatened violence. Imagined violence, when extreme, may be rated here. A rating of '2' or '3' would indicate the need for a safety plan.*

0	Youth has no evidence or history of aggressive behaviors or significant verbal aggression towards others (including people and animals).
1	History of aggressive behavior or verbal aggression towards others but no aggression during the past 30 days. History of fire setting (not in past year) would be rated here.
2	Occasional or moderate level of aggression towards others including aggression during the past 30 days or more recent verbal aggression.
3	Frequent or dangerous (significant harm) level of aggression to others. Youth is an immediate risk to others.

18. BULLYING - *This rating includes degrading or threatening behavior to other peers. Bullying might be verbal or physical in nature. A rating of 2 or 3 would indicate the need for a safety plan.*

0	Youth has never engaged in bullying at school, community or in a treatment/detention setting
1	Youth has been involved with groups that have bullied other youth either in school, community or treatment/detention setting; however, youth has not had a leadership role in these groups.
2	Youth has bullied other youth in school, community, or treatment/detention setting. Youth has either bullied the other youth individually or led a group that bullied youth
3	Youth has repeatedly utilized threats or actual violence to bully youth in school, community, or treatment/detention setting.

19. VICTIMIZATION - *This item is used to examine a history and level of current risk for victimization.*

0	This level indicates a person with no evidence of recent victimization and no significant history of victimization within the past year. The person may have been robbed or burglarized on one or more occasions in the past, but no pattern of victimization exists. Person is not presently at risk for re-victimization.
1	This level indicates a person with a history of victimization but who has not been victimized to any significant degree in the past year. Person is not presently at risk for re-victimization.
2	This level indicates a person who has been recently victimized (within the past year) but is not in acute risk of re-victimization. This might include physical or sexual abuse, significant psychological abuse by family or friend, extortion or violent crime.
3	This level indicates a person who has been recently victimized and is in acute risk of re-victimization. Examples include working as a prostitute or living in an abusive relationship.

20. SEXUAL AGGRESSION - *Sexually abusive behavior includes both aggressive sexual behavior and sexual behavior in which the youth takes advantage of a younger or less powerful child or adolescent through seduction, coercion, or force.*

0	No evidence of problems with sexual behavior in the past year.
1	Mild problems of sexually abusive behavior. For example, occasional inappropriate sexually aggressive/harassing language or behavior.
2	Moderate problems with sexually abusive behavior, For example, frequent inappropriate sexual behavior. Frequent disrobing would be rated here only if it was sexually provocative. Frequent inappropriate touching would be rated here.
3	Severe problems with sexually abusive behavior. This would include the rape or sexual abuse of another person involving sexual penetration.

21. SEXUALLY REACTIVE BEHAVIORS - *Sexually reactive behavior includes both age-inappropriate sexualized behaviors that may place a youth at risk for victimization or risky sexual practices.*

0	No evidence of problems with sexually reactive behaviors or high-risk sexual behaviors.
1	Some evidence of sexually reactive behavior. Youth may exhibit occasional inappropriate sexual language or behavior, flirts when age-inappropriate, or engages in unprotected sex with single partner. This behavior does not place youth at great risk. A history of sexually provocative behavior would be rated here.
2	Moderate problems with sexually reactive behavior that place youth at some risk. Youth may exhibit more frequent sexually provocative behaviors in a manner that impairs functioning, engage in promiscuous sexual behaviors or have unprotected sex with multiple partners.
3	Significant problems with sexually reactive behaviors. Youth exhibits sexual behaviors that place youth or others at immediate risk.

22. SUBSTANCE ABUSE - *These symptoms include use of alcohol and illegal drugs, the misuse of prescription medications and the inhalation of any substance for recreational purposes. This rating is consistent with DSM-IV Substance-related Disorders. Incarceration or placement in a treatment setting does not mean the substance abuse problem has been resolved. Consider keeping scores elevated if evidence suggests youth remains at risk.*

0	This rating is for a youth who has no substance use difficulties at the present time. If the person is in recovery for greater than 1 year, they should be coded here, although this is unlikely for a youth.
1	This rating is for a youth with mild substance use problems that might occasionally present problems for the person (intoxication, loss of money, reduced school performance, parental concern). This rating would be used for someone early in recovery (less than 1 year) who is currently abstinent for at least 30 days.
2	This rating is for a youth with a moderate substance abuse problem that impairs his/her ability to function in some areas of his/her life (e.g., school, social relationships, work, etc.).
3	This rating is for a youth with a severe substance dependence condition that consistently impairs his/her ability to function. Substance abuse problems may present significant complications to the coordination of care for the individual.

23. RUNAWAY - *In general, to classify as a runaway or elopement, the youth has run away from present home, OR has eloped from detention setting, treatment setting, or monitoring while on parole. Impulsive behavior that represents an immediate threat to personal safety would also be rated here.*

0	This rating is for a youth with no history of running away and no ideation involving escaping from the present living situation, treatment/detention setting or parole monitoring
1	This rating is for a youth with no recent history of running away but who has expressed ideation about escaping present home, detention setting, treatment setting, or monitoring while on parole. Youth may have threatened running away on one or more occasions or have a history (lifetime) of running away but not in the past year.
2	This rating is for a youth who has run away present home once OR a detention setting, treatment setting, or monitoring while on parole within the past year. Also rated here is a youth who has run away to home (parental or relative) in the past year.
3	This rating is for a youth who has (1) run away from home and/or treatment/detention setting, or parole monitoring within the last 7 days or (2) run away from home, detention/treatment setting, and/or parole monitoring twice or more overnight during the past 30 days. Destination is not a return to home of parent or relative.

24. FIRE SETTING - *This item refers to behavior involving the intentional setting of fires that might be dangerous to the youth or others. This does not include the use of candles or incense or matches to smoke.*

0	No evidence or history of fire setting behavior
1	History of fire-setting but not in past six months
2	Recent fire setting behavior (in past six months) but not of the type that has endangered the lives of others (e.g. playing with matches) OR repeated fire setting behavior over a period of at least two years even if not in the past six months.
3	Acute threat of fire setting. Set fire that endangered the lives of others (e.g. attempting to burn down a house).

IV. BEHAVIORAL/EMOTIONAL NEEDS (RISK FACTORS)

These ratings identify the behavioral health needs of the youth. While the CANS is not a diagnostic tool, it is designed to be consistent with diagnostic communication. In DSM-IV a diagnosis is defined by a set of symptoms that is associated with either dysfunction or distress. This definition is consistent with the ratings of '2' or '3' as defined by the action levels below:

For **Behavioral/Emotional Needs**, the following categories and symbols are used:

- 0** indicates a dimension where there is no evidence of any needs.
- 1** indicates a dimension that requires monitoring, watchful waiting, or preventive activities.
- 2** indicates a dimension that requires action to ensure that this identified need or risk behavior is addressed.
- 3** indicates a dimension that requires immediate or intensive action.

25. ANGER CONTROL - *This item captures the youth's ability to identify and manage their anger when frustrated.*

0	This rating indicates a youth with no evidence of any significant anger control problems.
1	This rating indicates a youth with some problems with controlling anger. He/she may sometimes become verbally aggressive when frustrated. Peers and family members are aware of and may attempt to avoid stimulating angry outbursts. Youth may have a history of physical aggression arising from inability to control anger, but none within the last 3 months.
2	This rating indicates a youth with moderate anger control problems. His/her temper has gotten him/her in significant trouble with peers, family, and/or school. This level may be associated with some physical violence, or increasing verbal outbursts. Others are likely quite aware of anger potential.
3	This rating indicates a youth with severe anger control problems. His/her temper is likely associated with frequent fighting that is often physical. Others likely fear him/her.

26. OPPOSITIONAL BEHAVIOR (Compliance with authority) - *This item is intended to capture how the youth relates to authority. Oppositional behavior is different from conduct disorder in that the emphasis of the behavior is on non-compliance with authority rather than inflicting damage and hurting others.*

0	This rating indicates that the youth is generally compliant.
1	This rating indicates that the youth has mild problems with compliance with some rules or adult instructions. Youth may occasionally talk back to teacher, parent/caregiver; there may be letters or calls from school.
2	This rating indicates that the youth has moderate problems with compliance with rules or adult instructions. A youth who meets the criteria for Oppositional Defiant Disorder in DSM-IV would be rated here.
3	This rating indicates that the youth has severe problems with compliance with rules or adult instructions. A youth rated at this level would be a severe case of Oppositional Defiant Disorder. They would be virtually always noncompliant. Youth repeatedly ignores authority.

27. CONDUCT - *These symptoms include antisocial behaviors like shoplifting, lying, vandalism, cruelty to animals, and assault. This dimension would include the symptoms of Conduct Disorder as specified in DSM-IV.*

0	This rating indicates a youth with no evidence of behavior disorder.
1	This rating indicates a youth with a mild level of conduct problems. The youth may have some difficulties in school and home behavior. Problems are recognizable but not notably deviant for age, sex, and community. This might include occasional truancy, repeated severe lying, or petty theft from family.
2	This rating indicates a youth with a moderate level of conduct disorder. This could include episodes of planned aggressive or other anti-social behavior. A youth rated at this level should meet the criteria for a diagnosis of Conduct Disorder.
3	This rating indicates a youth with a severe Conduct Disorder. This could include frequent episodes of unprovoked, planned aggressive or other anti-social behavior.

28. IMPULSIVITY - *Problems with impulse control or impulsive behaviors.*

0	This rating is used to indicate a youth with no evidence of age-inappropriate impulsivity in action or thought.
1	This rating is used to indicate a youth with evidence of mild levels of impulsivity evident in either action or thought. The youth may behave in a fashion that suggests limited impulse control. For instance, youth may yell out answers to questions or may have difficulty waiting his/her turn. Youth may exhibit some physical behaviors as well, for instance, pushing or shoving others without waiting turn.
2	This rating is used to indicate a youth with moderate levels of impulsivity evident in behavior. The youth is frequently impulsive and may represent a significant management problem. A youth who often intrudes on others and often exhibits aggressive impulses would be rated here.
3	This rating is used to indicate a youth with significant levels of impulsivity evident in behavior. Frequent impulsive behavior is observed or noted that carries considerable safety risk (e.g., running into the street, dangerous driving, or bike riding). The youth may be impulsive on a nearly continuous basis. He or she endangers self or others without thinking.

29. ATTENTION/HYPERACTIVITY - *Problems with attention, concentration and task completion would be rated here. These may include symptoms that are part of DSM-IV Attention-Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder. Inattention/distractibility not related to opposition would also be rated here.*

0	This rating is used to indicate a youth with no evidence of attention or concentration problems. This youth is able to stay on task in an age-appropriate manner.
1	This rating is used to indicate a youth with evidence of mild problems with attention or concentration. Youth may have some difficulties staying on task for an age-appropriate time period in school or play.
2	This rating is used to indicate a youth with moderate attention problems. In addition to problems with sustained attention, youth may become easily distracted or forgetful in daily activities, have trouble following through on activities, and become reluctant to engage in activities that require sustained effort. A youth who meets DSM-IV diagnostic criteria for ADHD would be rated here.
3	This rating is used to indicate a youth with severe impairment of attention or concentration. A youth with profound symptoms of ADHD or significant attention difficulties related to another diagnosis would be rated here.

30. PSYCHOSIS - *This item is used to rate symptoms of psychiatric disorders with a known neurological base. DSM-IV disorders included on this dimension are Schizophrenia and Psychotic disorders (unipolar, bipolar, NOS). The common symptoms of these disorders include hallucinations, delusions, unusual thought processes, strange speech, and bizarre/idiosyncratic behavior.*

0	This rating indicates a youth with no evidence of thought disturbances. Both thought processes and content are within normal range.
1	This rating indicates a youth with evidence of mild disruption in thought processes or content. The youth may be somewhat tangential in speech or evidence somewhat illogical thinking (age inappropriate). This also includes youth with a history of hallucinations but none currently. The category would be used for youth who are sub-threshold for one of the DSM diagnoses listed above.
2	This rating indicates a youth with evidence of moderate disturbance in thought processes or content. The youth may be somewhat delusional or have brief or intermittent hallucinations. The youth's speech may be at times quite tangential or illogical. This level would be used for youth who meet the diagnostic criteria for one of the disorders listed above.
3	This rating indicates a youth with severe psychotic disorder. The youth frequently is experiencing symptoms of psychosis and frequently has no reality assessment. There is evidence of ongoing delusions or hallucinations or both. Command hallucinations would be coded here. This level is used for extreme cases of the diagnoses listed above.

31. PARANOID THINKING - *This rating refers to suspiciousness and generalized mistrust of others. These beliefs are sometimes steadfastly maintained in the absence of any real supporting evidence.*

0	This rating is used to indicate a youth who does not appear to engage in any paranoid thinking
1	Youth is suspicious of others but is able to test out these suspicions and adjust his/her thinking appropriately.
2	Youth believes that others are 'out to get' him/her. Youth has trouble accepting that these beliefs may not be accurate. Youth at times is suspicious and guarded but at other times can be open and friendly.
3	Youth believes that others plan to cause him/her harm. Youth is nearly always suspicious and guarded.

32. DEPRESSION - *Symptoms included in this dimension are irritable or depressed mood, social withdrawal, sleep disturbances, weight/eating disturbances, and loss of motivation. This dimension can be used to rate symptoms of the following psychiatric disorders as specified in DSM-IV: Depressive Disorders (unipolar, dysthymia, NOS), Bipolar Disorder.*

0	This rating is given to a youth with no emotional problems. No evidence of depression.
1	This rating is given to a youth with mild emotional problems. Brief duration of depression, irritability, or impairment of peer, family, or academic functioning that does not lead to gross avoidance behavior.
2	This rating is given to a youth with a moderate level of emotional disturbance. Any diagnosis of depression would be coded here. This level is used to rate youth who meet the criteria for an affective disorder listed above.
3	This rating is given to a youth with a severe level of depression. This would include a youth who stays at home or in bed all day due to depression or one whose emotional symptoms prevent any participation in school, friendship groups, or family life. Disabling forms of depressive diagnoses would be coded here. This level is used to indicate an extreme case of one of the disorders listed above.

33. ANXIETY - *This item describes the youth's level of fearfulness, worrying or other characteristics of anxiety.*

0	No evidence of any anxiety or fearfulness.
1	History or suspicion of anxiety problems or mild to moderate anxiety associated with a recent negative life event. This level is used to rate either a mild phobia or anxiety problem or a sub-threshold level of symptoms for the other listed disorders.
2	Clear evidence of anxiety associated with either anxious mood or significant fearfulness. Anxiety has interfered significantly in youth's ability to function in at least one life domain.
3	Clear evidence of debilitating level of anxiety that makes it virtually impossible for the youth to function in any life domain

34. AFFECT DYSREGULATION - *These symptoms include difficulties modulating or expressing emotions, intense fear or helplessness, difficulties regulating sleep/wake cycle, and inability to fully engage in activities. This symptom is related to trauma, but may also be a symptom of bipolar disorder and some forms of head injury.*

0	This rating is given to a youth with no difficulties regulating emotional responses. Emotional responses are appropriate to the situation.
1	This rating is given to a youth with some minor difficulties with affect regulation. This youth could have some difficulty tolerating intense emotions and become somewhat jumpy or irritable in response to emotionally charged stimuli, or more watchful or hypervigilant in general. This youth may have some difficulty sustaining involvement in activities for any length of time.
2	This rating is given to a youth with moderate problems with affect regulation. This youth may be unable to modulate emotional responses. This youth may exhibit marked shifts in emotional responses (e.g., from sadness to irritability to anxiety) or have contained emotions with a tendency to lose control of emotions at various points (e.g., normally restricted affect punctuated by outbursts of anger or sadness). This youth may also exhibit persistent anxiety, intense fear or helplessness, or lethargy/loss of motivation.
3	This rating is given to a youth with severe problems with highly dysregulated affect. This youth may have more rapid shifts in mood and an inability to modulate emotional responses (feeling out of control of their emotions). This youth may also exhibit tightly contained emotions with intense outbursts under stress. Alternately, this youth may be characterized by extreme lethargy, loss of motivation or drive, and no ability to concentrate or sustain engagement in activities (i.e., emotionally "shut down").

35. SLEEP DIFFICULTIES - *This item rates any disruptions in sleep regardless of the cause including problems with going to bed, staying asleep, waking up early or sleeping too much.*

0	Youth gets a full night's sleep each night.
1	Youth has some problems sleeping. Generally, youth gets a full night's sleep but at least once a week problems arise. This may include occasionally awakening or bed wetting or nightmares.
2	Youth is having problems with sleep. Sleep is often disrupted and youth seldom obtains a full night of sleep.
3	Youth is generally sleep deprived. Sleeping is difficult for the youth and s/he is not able to get a full night's sleep

36. EATING DISTURBANCES - *These symptoms include problems with eating including disturbances in body image, refusal to maintain normal body weight, recurrent episodes of binge eating and hoarding food. These ratings are consistent with DSM-IV Eating Disorders.*

0	This rating is for a youth with no evidence of eating disturbances.
1	This rating is for a youth with a mild level of eating disturbance. This could include some preoccupation with weight, calorie intake, or body size or type when of normal weight or below weight. This could also include some binge eating patterns.
2	This rating is for a youth with a moderate level of eating disturbance. This could include a more intense preoccupation with weight gain or becoming fat when underweight, restrictive eating habits or excessive exercising in order to maintain below normal weight, and/or emaciated body appearance. This level could also include more notable binge eating episodes that are followed by compensatory behaviors in order to prevent weight gain (e.g., vomiting, use of laxatives, excessive exercising). This youth may meet criteria for a DSM-IV Eating Disorder (Anorexia or Bulimia Nervosa).
3	This rating is for a youth with a more severe form of eating disturbance. This could include significantly low weight where hospitalization is required or excessive binge-purge behaviors (at least once per day).

V. STRENGTHS

(**PROTECTIVE FACTORS at the Individual, Family, Peer and Community Level**)

These ratings describe a range of assets that youth and their environments may possess that can facilitate healthy development. An absence of a strength is not necessarily a need but an indication that strength building activities are indicated. In general strengths are more trait-like, stable characteristics; however, the 30 day rating window still applies unless over-ridden by the action levels as described below.

For **Strengths only**, the following categories and action levels are used:

- 0** indicate an item where strengths exist that can be used as a centerpiece for a strength-based plan.
- 1** indicates an item where strengths exist but require some strength-building efforts in order for them to serve as a focus of a strength-based plan.
- 2** indicates an item where strengths have been identified but require significant strength-building efforts before they can be effectively utilized as a focus of a strength-based plan.
- 3** indicates an item where efforts are needed in order to identify potential strengths on which to build.

37. FAMILY STRENGTHS - *Family refers to all family members as defined by the youth, or biological relatives and significant others with whom the youth is still in contact. Is the family (as defined by the youth) a support and strength to the youth?*

0	Significant family strengths. There is at least one family member who has a strong loving relationship with the youth and is able to provide significant emotional or concrete support.
1	Moderate level of family strengths. There is at least one family member with a strong loving relationship who is able to provide limited emotional or concrete support.
2	Mild level of family strengths. Family members are known, but currently none are able to provide emotional or concrete support.
3	This level indicates a youth with no known family strengths. There are no known family members.

38. INTERPERSONAL - *This rating refers to the interpersonal skills of the youth both with peers and adults. This is rated independent of Social Development because a youth can have skills but be struggling in their relationships at a particular point in time.*

0	Significant interpersonal strengths. Youth has close friends and is friendly with others.
1	Moderate level of interpersonal strengths. Youth may have a history of forming positive relationships with peers and/or non-caregivers. Youth may have at least one healthy relationship, is friendly with others.
2	Mild level of interpersonal strengths. Youth has some social skills that facilitate positive relationships with peers and adults but may not have any current healthy friendships.
3	Very limited ability to make and maintain positive relationships. Youth lacks social skills and has no history of positive relationships with peer and adults.

39. COPING AND SURVIVAL SKILLS - *This rating should be based on the strengths that the youth or adolescent might have developed including the ability to manage negative life experiences and the ability to develop skills to survive them. This should be rated independent of the youth's current level of distress.*

0	This level indicates a youth with exceptional psychological strengths, coping and survival skills. A youth able to recognize and use his/her strengths and creatively problem solve situations.
1	This level indicates a youth with good psychological strengths, coping and survival skills. The person has some coping skills for managing distress but they may struggle to problem solve various situations.
2	This level indicates a youth with limited psychological strengths, coping or survival skills. For example, a person with very low self-esteem would be rated here; or a youth who feels defeated frequently and can't identify ways to overcome a situation.
3	This level indicates a youth with no known psychological strengths, coping or identifiable survival skills. The youth fails to recognize his/her strengths and is therefore unable to utilize them. This may be due to intellectual impairment or serious psychiatric disorders.

40. OPTIMISM - *This rating should be based on the youth's sense of him/herself in his/her own future. This is intended to rate the youth's positive future orientation.*

0	Youth has a strong and stable optimistic outlook on his/her life. Youth is future oriented.
1	Youth is generally optimistic. Youth is likely able to articulate some positive future vision.
2	Youth has difficulties maintaining a positive view of him/herself and his/her life. Youth may be overly pessimistic.
3	Youth has difficulties seeing any positives about him/herself or his/her life.

41. TALENT/INTERESTS - *This rating should be based broadly on any talent, creative or artistic skill a youth may have including art, theatre, music, athletics, etc.*

0	This level indicates a youth with significant creative/artistic strengths. A youth who receives a significant amount of personal benefit from activities surrounding a talent would be rated here.
1	This level indicates a youth with a notable talent. For example, a youth who is involved in athletics or plays a musical instrument, etc. would be rated here.
2	This level indicates a youth who has expressed interest in developing a specific talent or talents even if they have not developed that talent to date.
3	This level indicates a youth with no known talents, interests, or hobbies.

42. SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS - *This rating should be based on the youth's and their family's involvement in spiritual or religious beliefs and activities.*

0	This level indicates a youth with strong moral and spiritual strengths. Youth may be very involved in a religious community or may have strongly held spiritual or religious beliefs that can sustain or comfort him/her in difficult times.
1	This level indicates a youth with some moral and spiritual strengths. Youth may be involved in a religious community.
2	This level indicates a youth with few spiritual or religious strengths. Youth may have little contact with religious institutions.
3	This level indicates a youth with no known spiritual or religious involvement.

43. COMMUNITY LIFE - *This rating should be based on the youth's level of involvement in the cultural aspects of life in his/her community.*

0	This level indicates a youth with extensive and substantial long-term ties with the community. For example, individual may be a member of a community group (e.g. Girl or Boy Scout etc.) for more than one year, may be widely accepted by neighbors, or involved in other community activities, informal networks, etc.
1	This level indicates a youth with significant community ties although they may be relatively short term (e.g. past year).
2	This level indicates a youth with limited ties and/or supports from the community.
3	This level indicates a youth with no known ties or supports from the community.

44. RELATIONSHIP PERMANENCE - *This rating refers to the stability of significant relationships in the youth's life. This likely includes family members but may also include other individuals.*

0	This level indicates a youth who has very stable relationships. Family members, friends, and community have been stable for most of his/her life and are likely to remain so in the foreseeable future. Youth is involved with both parents.
1	This level indicates a youth who has had stable relationships but there is some concern about instability in the near future (one year) due to transitions, illness, or age. A youth who has a stable relationship with only one parent may be rated here.
2	This level indicates a youth who has had at least one stable relationship over his/her lifetime but has experienced other instability through factors such as divorce, moving, removal from home, and death.
3	This level indicates a youth who does not have any stability in relationships.

VI. LIFE DOMAIN FUNCTIONING

(Both for RISK and Protective Factor Assessment)

These ratings describe how youths are doing in their various environments or life domains. The domains were identified from the children's research literature on wraparound philosophy. Functioning well in all life domains is the goal of a lifetime developmental framework. Please note that incarceration or placement in a treatment setting does not mean a need has been resolved. Consider keeping scores elevated if evidence suggests youth will once again exhibit poor functioning after release.

For **Life Functioning Domains**, the following categories and action levels are used:

- 0** indicates a dimension where there is no evidence of any needs.
- 1** indicates a dimension that requires monitoring, watchful waiting, or preventive activities.
- 2** indicates a dimension that requires action to ensure that this identified need or risk behavior is addressed.
- 3** indicates a dimension that requires immediate or intensive action.

45. MEDICAL/PHYSICAL - *This item refers to the youth's physical health status.*

0	Youth has no current health problems or chronic medical conditions.
1	Youth has mild/treatable medical problems that require medical treatment <i>or</i> youth has some physical condition that places mild limitations on activities. Conditions such as impaired hearing or vision would be rated here. Also rate here treatable medical conditions that result in physical limitations (e.g. asthma).
2	Youth has chronic illness that requires ongoing medical intervention/treatment <i>or</i> youth has physical condition that notably impacts activities.
3	Youth has life threatening illness or medical condition

46. DEVELOPMENTAL/INTELLECTUAL - *This item rates the presence of Developmental Disabilities or Mental Retardation. All developmental disabilities occur on a continuum; a youth with Autism may be designated a 0, 1, 2, or 3 depending on the significance of the disability and the impairment.*

0	No evidence of developmental problems or mental retardation.
1	Documented delay, learning disability, or documented borderline intellectual disability, (i.e. FSIQ 70 to 85.)
2	Evidence of a pervasive developmental disorder including Autism, Tourette's, Down's Syndrome or other significant developmental delay <i>or</i> youth has mild mental retardation (FSIQ 50 to 69).
3	Moderate, Severe, or Profound developmental disability or FSIQ below 50.

47. LANGUAGE - *This item includes both spoken and sign language. This item concerns any language-related needs a family might have that affect their participation in services.*

0	Youth and family have no problems communicating in English and do not require the assistance of a translator.
1	Youth and family speak some English but potential communication problems exist due to limits on vocabulary or understanding of the nuances of the language.
2	Youth and/or significant family members do not speak English. Translator or native language speaker is needed for successful intervention but qualified individual can be identified within natural supports.
3	Youth and/or significant family members do not speak English. Translator or native language speaker is needed for successful intervention and no such individual is available from among natural supports.

48. EDUCATIONAL SETTING - *This rating refers to whether the youth's community school system fits the particular needs of the youth. For youth currently in the community including on parole: rate the current school setting. For incarcerated youth: rate the last school setting in the community.*

0	This level indicates a youth who is in school and is involved with an educational plan (or IEP) that appears to exceed expectations. School works exceptionally well with family and caregivers to create a special learning environment that meets the youth's needs. Someone at the school goes above and beyond to take a healthy interest in the educational success of the youth.
1	This level indicates a youth who is in school and has a plan that appears to be effective. School works fairly well with family and caregivers to ensure appropriate educational development.
2	This level indicates a youth who is in school but has a plan that does not appear to be effective.
3	This level indicates a youth who is either not in school or is in a school setting that does not further his/her education.
NA	Not applicable for youth not required/expected to be in school.

49. SCHOOL BEHAVIOR - *This item rates the behavior of the youth in school or school-like settings. A rating of 3 would indicate a youth who is still having problems after special efforts have been made, i.e., problems in a special education class. Please note that incarceration or placement in a treatment setting does not mean a need has been resolved. Consider keeping scores elevated if evidence suggests youth will once again exhibit poor functioning after release.*

0	No evidence of behavior problems at school or day care. Youth is behaving well.
1	Youth is having mild behavioral problems at school. May be related to either relationships with teachers or peers. A single detention might be rated here.
2	Youth is having moderate behavioral difficulties at school. He/she is disruptive and may receive sanctions including suspensions or multiple detentions.
3	Youth is having severe problems with behavior in school. He/she is frequently or severely disruptive. School placement may be in jeopardy due to behavior.
NA	Not applicable for youth not required/expected to be in school.

50. SCHOOL ACHIEVEMENT - *This item describes academic achievement and functioning. For youth currently in the community including on parole: rate the current school setting. For incarcerated youth: rate the last school setting in the community. Consider keeping scores elevated if past evidence suggests youth will once again exhibit poor functioning after release.*

0	Youth is working at grade level, passing all classes and is on track with his/her educational plan.
1	Youth is doing adequately in school, although some problems with achievement exist.
2	Youth is having moderate problems with school achievement. He/she may be failing some subjects and/or be at risk for failing the current grade.
3	Youth is having severe achievement problems. He/she may be failing most subjects or is more than one year behind same age peers in school achievement, and/or will certainly not pass to next grade level.
NA	Not applicable for youth not required/expected to be in school.

51. SCHOOL ATTENDANCE - *If school is not in session, rate the last 30 days when school was in session. For youth currently in the community including on parole: rate the current school setting. For incarcerated youth: rate the last school setting in the community.*

0	No evidence of attendance problems. Youth attends regularly.
1	Youth has some problems attending school, although he/she generally goes to school. He/she may miss up to one day per week on average. Or, he/she may have had moderate to severe problems in the past six months but has been attending school regularly in the past month.
2	Youth is having problems with school attendance. He/she is missing at least two days per week on average.
3	Youth is generally truant or refusing to go to school or a school-aged youth not enrolled in school.
NA	Not applicable for youth who are no longer expected to be in school.

52. EDUCATIONAL ATTAINMENT - *This rates the degree to which the individual has completed his/her planned education.*

0	Individual has achieved all educational goals OR has no educational goals and educational attainment has no impact on lifetime vocational functioning.
1	Individual has set educational goals and is currently making progress towards achieving them.
2	Individual has set educational goals but is currently not making progress towards achieving them.
3	Individual has no educational goals and lack of educational attainment is interfering with individual's lifetime vocational functioning.

53. VOCATIONAL - *Generally this rating describes vocational interests and experience. Computer skills would be rated here.*

0	This level indicates a youth with vocational skills who is currently working in a natural environment.
1	This level indicates a youth with pre-vocational and some vocational skills but limited work experience.
2	This level indicates a youth with some pre-vocational skills but who is not presently working in any area related to those skills. This also may indicate a youth with a clear vocational preference.
3	This level indicates a youth with no known or identifiable vocational or pre-vocational skills and no expression of any future vocational preferences.

54. JOB FUNCTIONING - *This item is intended to describe functioning in vocational settings.*

0	Youth is gainfully employed in a job and experiencing no problems in attendance, performance or relationships at work.
1	Youth is gainfully employed but may have some difficulties at work with attendance, performance or relationships
2	Youth has significant job-related problems with attendance, performance, or relationships.
3	Youth is experiencing severe problems in an employment situation with performance or relationships. Youth may have recently been fired.
NA	Not applicable as the youth is not employed.

55. RECREATIONAL - *This item is intended to reflect the youth's access to and use of leisure time activities.*

0	Youth makes full use of leisure time to pursue recreational activities that support his/her healthy development and enjoyment.
1	Youth at times has difficulty using leisure time to pursue recreational activities.
2	Youth is having moderate problems with recreational activities, and may be unable to use leisure time to enjoy recreational activities.
3	Youth has no access to or interest in recreational activities. Youth has significant difficulties making use of leisure time.

56. TRANSPORTATION - *This item is used to rate the level of transportation while in the community required to ensure that the individual could effectively participate in his/her own treatment and in other life activities.*

0	The individual has no unmet transportation needs.
1	The individual has occasional unmet transportation needs (e.g., appointments). These needs would be no more than weekly and not require a special vehicle. The needs can be met with minimal support, for example, assistance with bus routes to facilitate independent navigation, or provision of a bus card.
2	The individual has occasional transportation needs that require a special vehicle or frequent transportation needs (e.g., daily to work or therapy) that do not require a special vehicle. Individual can self-transport with a med-van service.
3	The individual requires frequent (e.g., daily to work or therapy) transportation in a special vehicle. He or she is completely reliant on others for transportation and cannot self-transport.

57. FAMILY FUNCTIONING- *Family ideally should be defined by the youth; however, in the absence of this knowledge consider biological and adoptive relatives and their significant others with whom the youth has contact as the definition of family. Is the family (as defined by the youth) functioning well together?*

0	Youth gets along well with family members.
1	Youth is doing adequately in relationships with family members although some problems may exist. For example, some family members may have some problems in their relationships with youth.
2	Youth is having moderate problems with parents, siblings and/or other family members. Frequent arguing, difficulties in maintaining any positive relationship may be observed.
3	Youth is having severe problems with parents, siblings, and/or other family members. This would include problems of domestic violence, constant arguing, etc.

58. COMMUNITY LIVING SITUATION - *This item refers to how the youth is functioning in his/her current living arrangement in the community which could be with his caregiver, relative, in a temporary foster home, shelter, etc. For incarcerated youth, this would involve evaluating the current placement plan currently being considered for the youth upon release.*

0	Youth has a living situation (currently or upon release) in which needs are being met and the youth is functioning well.
1	Youth has a living situation (currently or upon release) which is not optimal because one or more needs are not able to be addressed or because the youth's functioning is not maximized in the setting.
2	Youth does not have an identified living situation in which needs can be met. Current or prospective living situation is moderately problematic both for the youth and for others in the environment.
3	Youth does not have any prospective living arrangements upon release or the current living situation is at immediate risk of deteriorating.

59. SOCIAL FUNCTIONING - *This item refers to the youth's social functioning from a developmental perspective.*

0	Youth interacts appropriately with others and builds and maintains relationships.
1	Youth is having some difficulty interacting with others and building and/or maintaining relationships.
2	Youth often has problems interacting with others and building and maintaining relationships.
3	Youth consistently and pervasively has problems interacting with others and building and maintaining relationships.

60. PEER INFLUENCES/GANG AFFILIATION – *This rating reflects the youth's social network in the community.*

0	Youth's primary peer social network does not engage in delinquent behavior.
1	Youth has peers in his/her primary peer social network who do not engage in delinquent behavior but has some peers who do.
2	Youth predominantly has peers who engage in delinquent behavior but youth is not a member of a gang.
3	Youth is a member of a gang whose membership encourages or requires illegal behavior as an aspect of gang membership.

61. INDEPENDENT LIVING SKILLS - *This rating focuses on the presence or absence of skills and impairments in independent living abilities or the readiness to take on those responsibilities while in the community*

0	This level indicates a person who is fully capable of independent living. No evidence of any deficits or barriers that could impede maintaining own home.
1	This level indicates a person with mild impairment of independent living skills. Some problems exist with maintaining reasonable cleanliness, diet and so forth. Problems with money management may occur at this level. These problems are generally addressable with training or supervision.
2	This level indicates a person with moderate impairment of independent living skills. Notable problems with completing tasks necessary for independent living are apparent. Difficulty with cooking, cleaning, and self-management when unsupervised would be common at this level. Problems are generally addressable with in-home services and supports.
3	This level indicates a person with profound impairment of independent living skills. This individual would be expected to be unable to live independently given their current status. Problems require a structured living environment.

62. TREATMENT INVOLVEMENT *This rating reflects the level of commitment by the youth and/or family to the services provided. Consider keeping scores elevated if past evidence suggests youth will once again exhibit poor compliance after release.*

0	Youth fully involved in his/her own treatment. Family supports treatment as well.
1	Youth and/or family involved in treatment, but not consistently. Youth may be somewhat involved in treatment, while family members are active or youth may be very involved in treatment while family members are unsupportive.
2	Youth and family are ambivalent about treatment involvement. Youth and/or family may be skeptical about treatment effectiveness or suspicious about clinician intentions.
3	Youth and family are uninterested in treatment involvement. A youth with treatment needs who is not currently in treatment would be rated here.

63. MEDICATION COMPLIANCE - *This rating focuses on the level of the individual's willingness or ability to participate in taking prescribed medications. For incarcerated youth: consider keeping scores elevated if past evidence suggests youth will once again exhibit poor compliance after release.*

0	This level indicates a person who self-administers any prescribed medications as prescribed and without reminders, or a person who is not currently on any medication.
1	This level indicates a person who will take prescribed medications routinely, but who sometimes needs reminders to maintain compliance. Also, a history of medication noncompliance but no current problems would be rated here.
2	This level indicates a person who is sporadically non-compliant. This person may be resistant to taking prescribed medications or this person may tend to overuse his or her medications. He/she might comply with prescription plans for periods of time (1-2 weeks) but generally does not sustain taking medication in prescribed dose or protocol. This would include youth who are sporadically noncompliant with medications for physical health that may place youth at medical risk.
3	This level indicates a person who has refused to take prescribed medications during the past 30-day period or a person who has abused his or her medications to a significant degree (i.e., overdosing or over using medications to a dangerous degree).

64. ANTICIPATION OF CONSEQUENCES - *This item describes the youth's decision-making processes and awareness of consequences.*

0	Youth is regularly able to anticipate consequences and adjust behavior. Youth knows and understands risk factors.
1	Youth is generally responsive to identified consequences; however, not all appropriate consequences have been identified or he/she may sometimes fail to anticipate consequences. Youth is knowledgeable about his/her risk factors and is generally able to take responsibility.
2	Youth responds to consequences on some occasions but sometimes does not appear to care about consequences for his/her behavior. Youth may have tendency to blame others but is sometimes able to accept some responsibility for his/her actions.
3	Youth is completely unresponsive to consequences for his/her behavior.

65. PAROLE/PROBATION COMPLIANCE - *This rating refers to the youth's compliance with any current probation or parole orders.*

0	Youth is fully compliant with parole/probation orders (e.g., school attendance, treatment, restraining orders)
1	Youth is in general compliance with parole/probation orders (e.g., occasionally missed appointments)
2	Youth is in partial noncompliance with parole/probation orders (e.g., youth is going to school but not attending court-order treatment)
3	Youth is in serious and/or complete noncompliance with parole/probation orders
NA	Youth is currently incarcerated

66. SEXUAL DEVELOPMENT - *This item looks at broad issues of sexual development, including sexual behavior, sexual identity, and the reactions of others to any of these factors.*

0	No evidence of any problems with sexual development.
1	Mild to moderate problems with sexual development. May include concerns about sexual identity or anxiety about the reactions of others.
2	Significant problems with sexual development. May include inappropriate distress due to gender identity issues, and/or some experience of negative reactions of others.
3	Profound problems with sexual development. This level would be the expectation of specific life-threatening reactions by others (e.g., hate crimes).

67. INTIMATE RELATIONSHIPS - *This item is used to rate the individuals current status in terms of romantic/intimate relationships.*

0	Adaptive partner relationship. Individual has a strong, positive, partner relationship with another adult, or they have maintained a positive partner relationship in the past but are not currently in an intimate relationship.
1	Mostly adaptive partner relationship. Individual has a generally positive partner relationship with another individual. This relationship may, at times, impede the individual's healthy development.
2	Limited adaptive partner relationship. The individual has a recent history of being in a domestically violent relationship or a recent history of being in a relationship where he/she was overly dependent on his/her partner. Individual may or may not be currently involved in any partner relationship with another individual.
3	Significant difficulties with partner relationships. Individual is currently involved in a negative or domestically violent relationship or a relationship where he/she is totally dependent on his/her partner.
NA	Not applicable. Individual has not yet been in an intimate relationship.

68. PARENTING ROLES - *This item is intended to rate the individual in any caregiver roles. For example, an individual with a son or daughter or an individual responsible for an elderly parent or grandparent would be rated here. Include pregnancy as a parenting role.*

0	Individual has a parenting role and he/she is functioning appropriately in that role.
1	The individual has responsibilities as a parent but occasionally experiences difficulties with this role.
2	The individual has responsibilities as a parent and either the individual is struggling with these responsibilities or these issues are currently interfering with the individual's functioning in other life domains.
3	The individual has responsibilities as a parent and the individual is currently unable to meet these responsibilities or these responsibilities are making it impossible for the individual to function in other life domains. Individual has the potential of abuse or neglect in his/her parenting.
NA	Not applicable. Individual is not a parent or is not engaged in any form of parenting role.

69. CHILD WELFARE INVOLVEMENT - *This item describes the youth's and/or family's involvement with the child protection side of the legal system.*

0	Youth/family is not involved with DCFS and has no history of child welfare involvement.
1	Youth/family has a history of DCFS involvement but no current open case or active involvement.
2	Youth is currently involved with Intact Families but is not in protective custody OR is in protective custody but the current placement is stable.
3	Youth is in protective custody and the current placement is at risk of disruption or there is no current placement.

VII. CAREGIVER NEEDS

(Both for Risk and Protective Factor Assessment)

These ratings should be completed for any current caregiver. For incarcerated youth, the caregiver is the person who is currently being considered as the primary placement plan for the youth.

For Caregiver Needs the following definitions and action levels apply:

- 0** indicates a dimension where there is no evidence of any needs. This may be a strength.
- 1** indicates a dimension that requires monitoring, watchful waiting, or preventive activities.
- 2** indicates a dimension that requires action to ensure that this identified need or risk behavior is addressed.
- 3** indicates a dimension that requires immediate or intensive action.

70. COMMITMENT TO YOUTH – *This item refers to the current caregiver that is being considered for placement. This rating relates to the level of involvement and commitment that the caregiver has in regards to being an active advocate for the youth.*

0	Parent/caregiver has a strong level of commitment and involvement with the youth and his/her advocate.
1	This level indicates a caregiver(s) who is consistently involved with the youth but is not an active advocate on behalf of the youth.
2	This level indicates a caregiver(s) who is minimally involved in the care of the youth and requires assistance in understanding their role further.
3	This level indicates a caregiver(s) who is uninvolved with the care of the youth. Caregiver may want individual out of home or may no longer want the responsibility of being his/her caregiver.

71. SAFETY - *This rating refers to the safety of the assessed youth. It does not refer to the safety of other family or household members based on any danger presented by the assessed youth.*

0	This level indicates that the present placement is safe for the youth in his or her present condition.
1	This level indicates that while the environment is currently safe, unsafe circumstances in the past warrant continued monitoring of previously assessed safety threats.
2	Threats to safety have been identified but may be effectively managed by caregiver protective capacities and supportive services.
3	Safety threats have been identified and caregiver protective capacities are not sufficient to ensure the youth's safety. Safety plan or protective custody has occurred.

72. SUPERVISION - *This rating is used to determine the parent/caregiver's capacity to provide the level of monitoring needed by the youth.*

0	This rating is used to indicate a caregiver circumstance in which supervision and monitoring are appropriate and functioning well.
1	This level indicates a caregiver circumstance in which supervision is generally adequate but inconsistent. This may include a placement in which one member is capable of appropriate monitoring and supervision but others are not capable or not consistently available.
2	This level indicates a caregiver circumstance in which appropriate supervision and monitoring are very inconsistent and frequently absent.
3	This level indicates a caregiver circumstance in which appropriate supervision and monitoring are nearly always absent or inappropriate.

73. DISCIPLINE - *Discipline is defined as all parenting behaviors and strategies that support positive behavior in youth.*

0	Parent/caregiver generally demonstrates an ability to discipline her/his children in a consistent and respectful manner. Parent/caregiver's expectations are age-appropriate and he/she usually is able to set age appropriate limits and to enforce them.
1	Parent/caregiver is often able to set age appropriate limits and to enforce them. On occasion her/his interventions may be too harsh, too lenient, or inconsistent. At times, her/his expectations of her/his children may be too high or too low.
2	Parent/caregiver demonstrates limited ability to discipline his/her children in a consistent and age-appropriate manner. She/he rarely is able to set age appropriate limits and to enforce them. Her/his interventions may be erratic and overly harsh but not physically harmful. Her/his expectations of her/his children are frequently unrealistic.
3	Significant difficulties with discipline methods. Parent/caregiver disciplines her/his children in an unpredictable fashion. There is either an absence of limit setting and disciplinary interventions or the limit setting and disciplinary interventions are rigid, extreme, and physically harmful (such as shaking the youth, whipping, etc.).

74. KNOWLEDGE OF YOUTH'S NEEDS - *This rating should be based on caregiver's knowledge of the specific strengths of the youth and any needs experienced by the youth and their ability to understand the rationale for the treatment or management of these problems.*

0	This level indicates that the parent/caregiver is fully knowledgeable about the youth's psychological strengths and needs, talents and limitations.
1	This level indicates that the parent/caregiver, while being generally knowledgeable about the youth, has some mild deficits in knowledge or understanding of either the youth's psychological condition or his/her talents, skills and assets.
2	This level indicates that the parent/caregiver does not know or understand the youth well and that significant deficits exist in the caregiver's ability to relate to the youth's problems and strengths.
3	This level indicates that the parent/caregiver has little or no understanding of the youth's current condition. The placement is unable to cope with the youth given his/her status at the time, not because of the needs of the youth but because the caregiver does not understand or accept the situation.

75. ORGANIZATION - *This rating should be based on the ability of the parent/caregiver to participate in or direct the organization of the household, services, and related activities.*

0	Parent/caregiver is well organized and efficient in coordinating household, services, and activities
1	Parent/caregiver has minimal difficulties with organizing or maintaining household to support needed services. For example, may be forgetful about appointments or occasionally fails to call back case manager.
2	Parent/caregiver has moderate difficulty organizing or maintaining household to support needed services.
3	Parent/caregiver is unable to organize household to support needed services.

76. FINANCIAL STATUS - *This item refers to the family's income regardless of its source in comparison to the family's financial needs.*

0	Family has financial resources necessary to meet needs or has limited resources but is effectively utilizing those to meet needs.
1	Family has financial resources necessary to meet most needs; however, some limitations exist.
2	Family has financial difficulties that limit their ability to meet significant family needs.
3	Family is experiencing financial hardship that has made them unable to meet family needs.

77. PHYSICAL/BEHAVIORAL HEALTH – *This rating refers to the physical and behavioral health includes medical, physical, mental health, and substance abuse challenges faced by the caregiver(s).*

0	Caregiver(s) has no physical or behavioral health limitations that impact assistance or attendant care.
1	Caregiver(s) has some physical or behavioral health limitations that interfere with provision of assistance or attendant care.
2	Caregiver(s) has significant physical or behavioral health limitations that prevent them from being able to provide some of needed assistance or make attendant care difficult.
3	Caregiver(s) is physically unable to provide any needed assistance or attendant care.